

Right Fresh produce, seafood, and curios can be found in the covered Central Market

Below The chicken takes its color and heat from the small but feisty piri-iri pepper, also known as the bird's-eye chili or African red devil



A Day in Maputo

Easily and safely explored on foot, central Maputo is a compact grid of shady avenues filled with unexpected architectural curiosities.

MORNING Start at Praça dos Trabalhadores and **Maputo Railway Station**, the palatial 1910 creation of Gustave Eiffel. From here, the bar-lined **Rua de Bagamoio** (once known as the “Street of Trouble” by visiting sailors) leads through the old town to the 18th-century **Fortalezada Nossa Senhora da Conceição**, the city’s oldest extant building and home to interesting artworks. Take a short ferry ride to rustic **Catembe** for fabulous views and an inexpensive seafood lunch at the redoubtable **Restaurant Diogo** on the beach.

AFTERNOON Take the ferry back and follow Av. Patrice Lumumba uphill to the prestigious **Polana District** and shady **Av. Friedrich Engels** for cliff-top views over the harbor.

EVENING Dive into the fantastic **Barracas de Museu** for a drink or two before or after dinner.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Maputo is Mozambique’s main **port** of entry, and the **international airport** is only 10 minutes from downtown, traffic permitting.

WHERE TO STAY

Fatima’s Place (inexpensive) is a popular owner-managed hostel with dorms and private rooms. www.mozambiquebackpackers.com
Hotel Villa das Mangas (moderate) is a small central boutique hotel set around a pretty garden with a pool. www.hipchichotels.net
 The ocean-facing **Serena Polana** (expensive) has been Maputo’s most prestigious address since it opened in 1922. www.serenahotels.com

FURTHER INFORMATION

Mike Slater’s detailed www.mozguide.com is very useful.

